

Chapter 4: Presentation & Communication Skills

Class 20 – Public Speaking & Voice Modulation

Learning Objectives

After completing this lesson, students will be able to:

- Understand the meaning and importance of public speaking.
 - Identify the characteristics of an effective speaker.
 - Develop confidence while speaking before an audience.
 - Apply voice modulation techniques for better communication.
 - Improve pronunciation, fluency, pace, and volume.
 - Practice delivering short speeches with confidence.
 - Use public speaking skills in academic and real-life situations.
-

Introduction

Public speaking is the ability to speak confidently and effectively in front of an audience. It is an important life skill used in classrooms, competitions, meetings, seminars, interviews, and professional careers.

Many students feel nervous while speaking before others. However, with regular practice, proper preparation, and good communication techniques, anyone can become a confident speaker.

Voice modulation—the way we change our tone, pitch, speed, and volume while speaking—makes speeches more interesting and helps keep the audience engaged.

What is Public Speaking?

Public Speaking is the process of delivering information, ideas, or opinions to an audience in a clear, confident, and organized manner.

It involves:

- Speaking clearly
 - Maintaining confidence
 - Organizing ideas
 - Engaging the audience
 - Communicating effectively
-

Importance of Public Speaking

Public speaking helps students to:

- Build self-confidence.
 - Improve communication skills.
 - Express ideas clearly.
 - Develop leadership qualities.
 - Improve classroom participation.
 - Perform better in presentations.
 - Prepare for interviews and competitions.
 - Inspire and influence others.
-

Characteristics of a Good Public Speaker

A good speaker should:

- Speak confidently.
 - Be well prepared.
 - Maintain eye contact.
 - Use clear pronunciation.
 - Organize ideas logically.
 - Use positive body language.
 - Respect the audience.
 - Finish within the given time.
-

Overcoming Stage Fear

Many students experience nervousness before speaking. These tips can help:

- Prepare your speech in advance.

- Practice several times.
 - Take deep breaths before speaking.
 - Start with a smile.
 - Focus on your message instead of your fear.
 - Speak slowly and clearly.
 - Maintain eye contact with different parts of the audience.
 - Remember that mistakes are a normal part of learning.
-

What is Voice Modulation?

Voice Modulation is the ability to change your voice to make speech more interesting, expressive, and meaningful.

Voice modulation includes:

- Tone
- Pitch
- Volume
- Speed (Pace)
- Pauses
- Emphasis

Using voice modulation helps listeners stay interested and understand the message better.

Voice Modulation Techniques

1. Tone

Tone expresses emotions while speaking.

Examples:

- Friendly
- Serious
- Excited
- Calm
- Motivational

Choose a tone that matches the topic.

2. Pitch

Pitch refers to how high or low your voice sounds.

- Higher pitch can express excitement.
- Lower pitch can express seriousness or confidence.

Avoid speaking in the same pitch throughout the speech.

3. Volume

Volume is the loudness or softness of your voice.

Students should:

- Speak loudly enough for everyone to hear.
 - Avoid shouting.
 - Adjust volume according to the room size.
-

4. Pace

Pace means the speed of speaking.

A good speaker:

- Speaks neither too fast nor too slowly.
 - Slows down when explaining important ideas.
 - Speeds up slightly during simple information.
-

5. Pauses

Pauses give the audience time to understand important points.

Use pauses:

- After asking a question.
- Before introducing a key idea.
- Between important sections.

Avoid saying "um," "ah," or "you know" repeatedly.

6. Emphasis

Emphasis means stressing important words or phrases.

Example:

"Every student can become a confident speaker."

Stress the words **"Every student"** and **"confident speaker."**

Pronunciation and Fluency

Students should:

- Pronounce words clearly.
- Speak complete sentences.
- Practice difficult words.
- Avoid mumbling.
- Maintain a natural speaking rhythm.

Fluent speaking improves audience understanding.

Confidence Building Techniques

To build confidence:

- Practice daily.
 - Read aloud.
 - Record your voice and listen.
 - Participate in classroom discussions.
 - Volunteer for speeches.
 - Practice in front of family or friends.
 - Learn from feedback.
-

One-Minute Speech Practice

Students can practice short speeches on topics such as:

- My School
 - My Favourite Teacher
 - Save Water
 - Healthy Lifestyle
 - Artificial Intelligence
 - My Favourite Sport
 - Environmental Protection
 - Digital Safety
 - Importance of Reading
 - My Career Dream
-

Common Public Speaking Mistakes

Avoid:

- Speaking too fast.
 - Reading directly from notes.
 - Speaking too softly.
 - Avoiding eye contact.
 - Standing without confidence.
 - Using too many filler words.
 - Speaking without preparation.
 - Ignoring the audience.
-

Real-Life Applications

Public speaking is useful in:

- Classroom presentations
- Debates
- School assemblies
- Competitions
- Interviews
- Business meetings
- Conferences

- Leadership activities
 - Community events
 - Professional careers
-

Career Opportunities

Public speaking skills are valuable for careers such as:

- Teacher
 - Lawyer
 - News Presenter
 - Journalist
 - Motivational Speaker
 - Politician
 - Business Executive
 - Corporate Trainer
 - Television Anchor
 - Public Relations Officer
-

Revision

Students should revise:

- Public Speaking
 - Importance of Public Speaking
 - Voice Modulation
 - Tone
 - Pitch
 - Volume
 - Pace
 - Pauses
 - Pronunciation
 - Confidence Building Techniques
-

Did You Know?

- Public speaking is one of the most important professional skills in almost every career.
 - Voice modulation helps audiences stay interested and understand messages more clearly.
 - Practicing short speeches regularly improves confidence and fluency.
 - Eye contact and body language are as important as spoken words during presentations.
-

Points to Remember

- Prepare before speaking.
- Speak clearly and confidently.
- Use voice modulation to make your speech interesting.
- Maintain eye contact and positive body language.
- Practice regularly to improve your public speaking skills.